

Sudanese Henna

الحناء السودانية

Lawsonia inermis

Powder and cleaned leaves

<i>Lawsonia inermis</i> L.	Lawsonone	1404.90
Botanical source	Colouring matter	HS code (indicative)

1 Scope

This sheet specifies henna powder: the ground, sun-dried leaves of *Lawsonia inermis* with nothing added, as exported by Asmagh Sudanese Exports from Port Sudan. It does not cover products made from henna, such as mixed hair colours or pastes.

2 Synonyms

Henna
Mehndi
<i>Lawsonia alba</i> Lam.
CAS 84988-66-9

3 Definition

The dried leaf and petiole of *Lawsonia inermis* L. (syn. *Lawsonia alba* Lam.), a shrub of the family Lythraceae. Its colouring matter is lawsone (2-hydroxy-1,4-naphthoquinone). In the leaf, lawsone is mostly bound as glycosides; it is released when the powder is soaked in water and stains hair, skin and nails reddish-brown.

4 Description

A fine, olive-green to brownish-green powder with the characteristic odour of henna, milled from leaves grown mainly in northern Sudan along the Nile and dried in the sun.

5 Grades and forms

Henna powder	Milled from cleaned, sun-dried leaves, with nothing added
Cleaned leaves	Sun-dried, cleaned of stems and sand
Available as	Powder Leaves

6 Functional uses

A natural dye for hair, skin and nails, and an ingredient in natural hair-care and cosmetic products. Permitted uses differ by market; see section 8.5.



Hair colour and care



Body art, where permitted



Natural cosmetics

7 Anatomical description

Under the microscope, ground henna leaves show these structures (IS 11142):

Colour and crystals Olive-green or brownish-green fragments of cuticle and leaf parenchyma, with rosette aggregates and monoclinic prisms of calcium oxalate, often up to 15 µm and occasionally up to 40 µm across.	Mucilage cells Globular mucilage cells.
Fibres and vascular tissue Numerous fragments of vascular tissue; long, narrow and shorter fusiform sclerenchyma fibres with thick walls, some of them wavy-toothed.	Epidermis and stomata Fragments of epidermis with stomata and striated cuticle. The stomata are surrounded by ordinary epidermal cells; occasional papillae or fragments of non-glandular hairs.

8 Requirements

8.1 General requirements

- | | |
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| ✓ Has the characteristic aromatic odour of henna | ✓ Free from abnormal odour and colour |
| ✓ Free from live or dead insects, their fragments and rodent contamination | ✓ Free from lumps and mould |
| ✓ Free from added dyes and other additives | ✓ Free from pesticide residues, fertiliser and harmful chemicals |

8.2 Technical requirements

	Lawsonone ≥ 1.0 % colouring matter, IS 11142 Cold-water extract 25 - 32 % IS 11142 Moisture ≤ 10 % US 21 CFR 73.2190; IS 11142 Total ash ≤ 15 % US 21 CFR 73.2190 Acid-insoluble ash ≤ 5 % US 21 CFR 73.2190	Crude fibre 10 - 15 % IS 11142 Plant parts other than leaf and petiole ≤ 10 % US 21 CFR 73.2190 Impurities and dust ≤ 1 % Syrian Standard 1502 Added dyes None passes the extraneous-dye test, IS 11142
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Percent by mass. Sources: US 21 CFR 73.2190 (US colour additive listing for henna), IS 11142:1984 (Indian standard for henna powder), Syrian Standard 1502/1995.

8.3 Metal contaminants

Lead ≤ 20 mg/kg US 21 CFR 73.2190	Arsenic ≤ 1 mg/kg Syrian Standard 1502 (US limit 3 mg/kg)	Cadmium ≤ 1 mg/kg Syrian Standard 1502	Mercury ≤ 1 mg/kg Syrian Standard 1502
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8.4 Microbiological criteria (Syrian Standard 1502)

Total bacterial count	≤ 10 000 cfu/g	
Yeasts and moulds	≤ 100 000 cfu/g	

8.5 Permitted uses by market

United States

Henna is a colour additive exempt from certification for colouring hair only (US 21 CFR 73.2190). It may not be used on eyelashes, eyebrows or around the eyes, and the label must warn against use near the eyes and on a cut or abraded scalp.

Buyers are responsible for checking the rules for their product and market.

European Union

The Scientific Committee on Consumer Safety found henna safe as a hair dye (SCCS/1511/13), based on batches with up to 1.4 % lawsone, used as 100 g of powder mixed with 300 ml of boiling water. Use as body paint was not assessed.

9 Storage

Store in a clean, dry and cool place, low in humidity, protected from light and dust, on pallets off the floor.

10 Packaging

New, clean bags of 25 kg or 50 kg net, made of materials that do not affect the product. Powder is packed in polyethylene-lined bags to keep out moisture and dust.

Other packing on request.

Container load about 20–22 MT per 20 ft container.



11 Labelling

Every bag is marked clearly with:

Product name  Henna powder	Composition  100 % <i>Lawsonia inermis</i> leaf	Production and best-before date  Month and year	Lot number  Traceable to intake lot
Net weight (kg)  25 or 50 kg	Country of origin  Sudan	Producing company  Asmagh Sudanese Exports	Storage conditions  Keep dry, cool and away from light

12 Shelf life

Up to 3 years from the date of production when stored as in section 9 (Syrian Standard 1502).

13 Sampling and testing

Sampling follows IS 11142: bags are chosen at random from each lot, and a composite sample of at least 0.5 kg is split three ways, for the buyer, the supplier and a sealed referee sample.

Tests follow IS 7159 (methods of test for henna powder) and AOAC methods. Each shipment carries an analysis and quality certificate issued by the Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO).

From farm to port

من المزرعة إلى الميناء

Every lot is sampled on arrival, cleaned of stems and sand, milled and tested before it is packed. Storage and loading are checked too, because quality can be lost after processing.

1 Our quality process

1



Sourcing

Bought from trusted growers and traders; every incoming lot is checked.

2



Cleaning

Stems, sand and impurities removed by hand and machine.

3



Milling

Cleaned, sun-dried leaves milled into fine powder, or supplied whole.

4



Testing

Samples tested for moisture, impurities and the parameters in the buyer's specification.

5



Packing

Packed in new, clean bags marked with product, lot and weight.

6



Storage

Kept dry and ventilated, off the floor and away from contamination until loading.

7



Loading

Containers inspected before stuffing; loading is supervised.

8



Shipping

Shipped from Port Sudan with the full set of export documents.

2 Origin and shipping

Sudanese henna is grown mainly in the north of the country, along the Nile, and is known for a rich, long-lasting colour. It travels from the farms to Port Sudan on the Red Sea for export.

HS code	1404.90 (indicative; confirm with your customs broker)
Port of loading	Port Sudan (SDPZU), Red Sea
Container load	About 20–22 MT per 20 ft container
Ready to load	Usually 10–15 days after contract
Transit	About 2–8 weeks, by destination
Delivery terms	FOB Port Sudan, CFR or CIF
Payment terms	Irrevocable L/C at sight, TT advance, or D/P
Samples	Free; courier paid by the buyer



3 Export documents

Certificates travel with each shipment and are exchanged through the banks or directly with the buyer, so the goods clear customs at destination.

Product certificates



Certificate of origin
Sudan Chamber of Commerce; general or preferential forms.



Phytosanitary certificate
Official inspection against the importing country's pest list.



Analysis and quality certificate
Issued by the Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO).



Fumigation certificate
Treatment, chemical, dose and temperature used.



Inspection certificate
Optional; by an international inspection company chosen by the buyer.

Shipping documents



Export contract
Attested by the Ministry of Trade and the Chamber of Commerce.



Commercial invoice
Goods, quantity, value and terms.



Packing list
Every bag in each container, with counts and weights.



Bill of lading
Issued by the shipping line on loading.

4 Standards and references

- US Code of Federal Regulations, 21 CFR 73.2190, Henna (colour additives exempt from certification).
- Bureau of Indian Standards. IS 11142:1984, Specification for henna powder (since revised as IS 11142:2023); IS 7159, Methods of test for henna powder.
- Syrian Standard No.1502/1995, Ground henna.
- Scientific Committee on Consumer Safety. Opinion on *Lawsonia inermis* (henna), SCCS/1511/13 (2013; corrigendum 2021). European Commission.
- AOAC International. Official Methods of Analysis.

